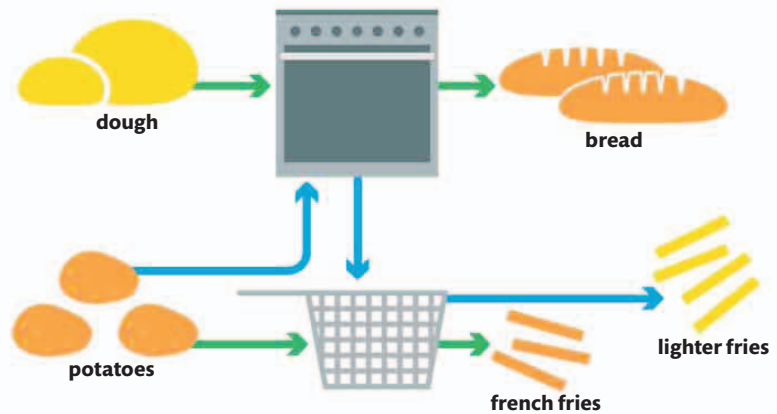


HYBRID PROCESSES FOR INNOVATION

By combining manufacturing processes, companies can create products with new and original qualities. For instance, a food company that makes bread and french fries may speed up production of the fries by baking them in the bread oven first. This has the unintended but beneficial consequence of making the fries healthier. A new product is created, which may now be marketed as a new proposition to a different set of consumers.



Job production

One worker creates a one-of-a-kind product, such as a custom kitchen, from start to finish. This way of working can be more rewarding for the worker, who uses a range of skills, but it tends to be costly for the customer. See pp.272–273.



Cell manufacturing

Combining the best of flow and job production, here a group of products or parts is produced in separate small units (cells) made up of a number of workers in the factory. Workers are trained to produce all the items in the set. Dissimilar items can be produced without slowing the production line. The idea is to improve performance by giving each cell a degree of autonomy.

